The Test Holds

S&P −0.22% to 7,109 absorbing weekend escalation. Both IOWN sleeves positive, beating every benchmark. Bitcoin +3.33% to $76,281. STLD +4.51% into post-close print.

THE SESSION

The session absorbed the weekend without breaking. The S&P closed −0.22% at 7,109, the Nasdaq gave back 0.26% to snap a 13-day winning streak that ranked as its longest since 1992, and the Dow finished flat. The Russell 2000 bucked the tape with a +0.58% session and a new closing record at 2,793. Futures pointed down 0.4% before the open after a weekend in which the US Navy seized an Iranian cargo ship and Iran fired at vessels while halting traffic in the Strait of Hormuz. The broad tape ended with a red tint, but the reaction function was measured rather than reactive.

Crude rebid the geopolitical risk that Friday's session had unwound. WTI rose roughly 5% back above $86 and Brent climbed above $95, but both stayed well below the $100 level that defined the war-premium regime through March. Gold retraced 0.93% from Friday's advance. The VIX ticked up to 18.87 (+7.95%), registering the weekend's news without signaling stress. Bitcoin was the clearest outlier, adding 3.33% to $76,281 as digital-asset flows decoupled from the macro jitters.

Both IOWN sleeves finished higher against red benchmarks. Dividend gained 0.26%, beating DVY (+0.14%) and SPY (−0.20%). Growth Portfolio added 0.52%, beating IUSG (−0.42%) and SPY. The outperformance came from breadth, not a single beta trade: a Bitcoin miner, a steelmaker into its print, a semiconductor leader, a crypto exchange, and an auto-exposed chip name all contributed. Energy-linked holdings firmed modestly as crude rebid, but the positioning did not require a return to war-premium pricing to work.

IOWN Tactical: The recovery from the March 30 low at 6,341 to Friday's 7,101 print was a 12% advance in three weeks. Today was the first test of whether that pricing could absorb bad news. It did. One session doesn't retire the question, but it establishes that owning the thesis through a weekend headline was the right trade.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

HUT +5.46% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Bitcoin +3.33% to $76,281 pulled miners higher, with HUT amplifying BTC moves through its leveraged treasury and AI-infrastructure pivot narrative. Close $78.99.

STLD +4.51% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Steel Dynamics rallied into tonight's Q1 print. Company guided $2.73–$2.77 in March vs. $1.44 a year ago, citing metal-margin expansion and strong non-residential construction, energy, automotive, and industrial demand. Call tomorrow 11am ET. Close $209.35.

ADI +2.58% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Bank of America lifted the price target to $425 last week; Citi has the name on its positive catalyst watch. Momentum in analog/mixed-signal tied to AI datacenter and industrial end-markets continues. Close $381.05.

COIN +2.57% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Coinbase and Bybit announced a partnership on tokenization of stocks. Bitcoin strength reinforced the tape. Close $211.63.

NXPI +2.46% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Auto and industrial analog/mixed-signal strength carried the name alongside ADI. Close $221.34.

DECLINERS

ETHA –4.13% — DIGITAL ASSET ETF

Ether weakness decoupled from Bitcoin's rally; capital rotated within digital assets toward BTC. Close $17.62.

CL –2.66% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

No specific catalyst; consumer staples rotation continued as risk appetite held elsewhere. Close $83.53.

GFI –2.36% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gold −0.93% as Friday's safe-haven bid faded partially. Close $48.78.

LMT –1.84% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Mixed news: State Dept approved a potential $11.9B Germany combat-systems deal with Lockheed and RTX, but Peru postponed its $2B F-16 program. Close $581.28.

LRCX –1.66% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Semiconductor equipment diverged from chip designers today, giving back some of the prior run. Close $263.16.

HOLDINGS NEWS

STLD reports Q1 2026 after the close tonight (Dividend Strategy). March guidance of $2.73–$2.77 per diluted share compares to Q4 2025's $1.82 and prior-year Q1's $1.44. Strong metal-margin expansion and expanding aluminum operations are the themes; share repurchase was slowed in Q1 due to working capital funding for the aluminum ramp and annual profit-sharing.

Call Tuesday 11am ET.

LMT (Dividend Strategy). The State Department approved a potential $11.9B foreign military sale to Germany for combat systems, with Lockheed Martin and RTX as primary contractors. Separately, Peru postponed its $2B F-16 program decision. The stock finished −1.84% on the net.

COIN (Growth Portfolio). Coinbase announced a partnership with Bybit on tokenization of equities, extending the regulated-exchange footprint into tokenized real-world assets.

Upcoming IOWN reporters this week: GPC (Dividend Strategy) and TEL (Dividend Strategy). MATX confirmed Q1 release for May 4.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✓ BEAT BOTH

+0.26%

vs. DVY +0.14% | SPY –0.20%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✓ BEAT

+0.52%

vs. IUSG –0.42%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +10.92% vs DVY +8.67% / SPY +3.93%
Growth +4.81% vs IUSG +3.39% / SPY +3.93%